US PORT CLEARANCE MARKET STUDY 2023

Operator Market Analysis & Regional Revenue Distribution

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Total Market Revenue: $169.1M
Total Clearances: 49,726
Unique Vessels: 9,045
Analysis Period: 2023
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Report Generated: February 06, 2026

USACE Port Clearance Analysis

1. Executive Summary

Overview of the US port clearance market for 2023

USACE Market Study 2023 - Key Statistics

$169.1M

Total Revenue

49,726

Total Clearances

9,045

Unique Vessels

$3,401

Avg Fee

2.9%

Top 10 Market Share

409

Grain Shipments

Key Findings

- Market generated $169.1M in revenue from 49,726 clearances
- Top 10 vessels account for 2.9% of total market revenue
- Top 50 vessels account for 7.9% of total market revenue
- Market concentration (HHI): 4 - indicates moderate concentration
- 61 distinct vessel types operating across 11 regions
- Average clearance fee: $3,401
- Grain shipments: 409 (0.8% of total)
- Multi-visit vessels: 6,586 | Single-visit: 2,459

2. Market Overview

Total market size, clearance volume, and concentration metrics

Market Metrics

Total Revenue: $169,142,950

Total Clearances: 49,726

Average Fee per Clearance: $3,401

Unique Vessels: 9,045

HHI (Market Concentration): 4

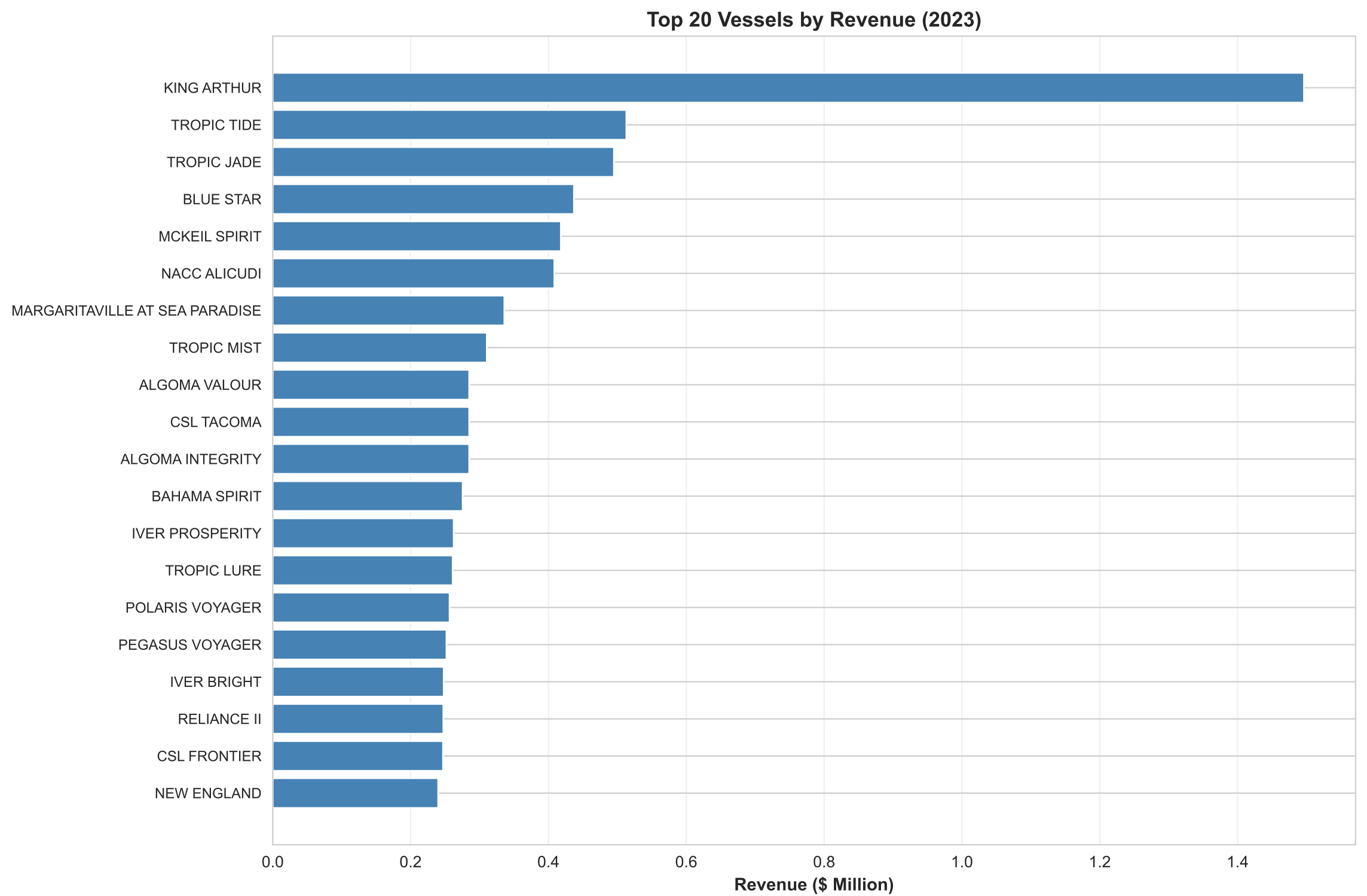
Multi-Visit Vessels: 6,586

Single-Visit Vessels: 2,459

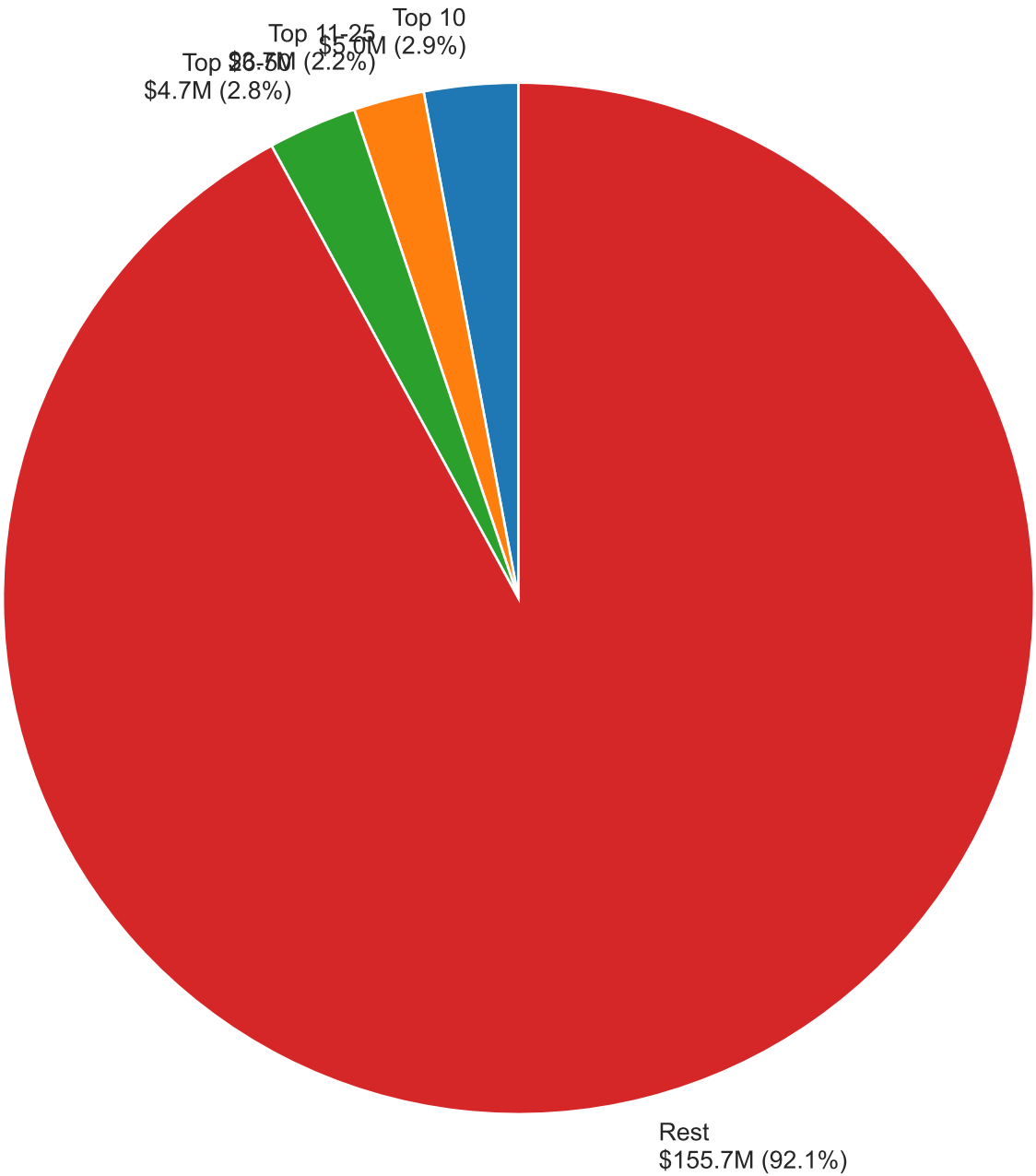
- HHI above 2,500 indicates high market concentration
- HHI between 1,500-2,500 indicates moderate concentration
- Current HHI of 4 suggests moderate concentration

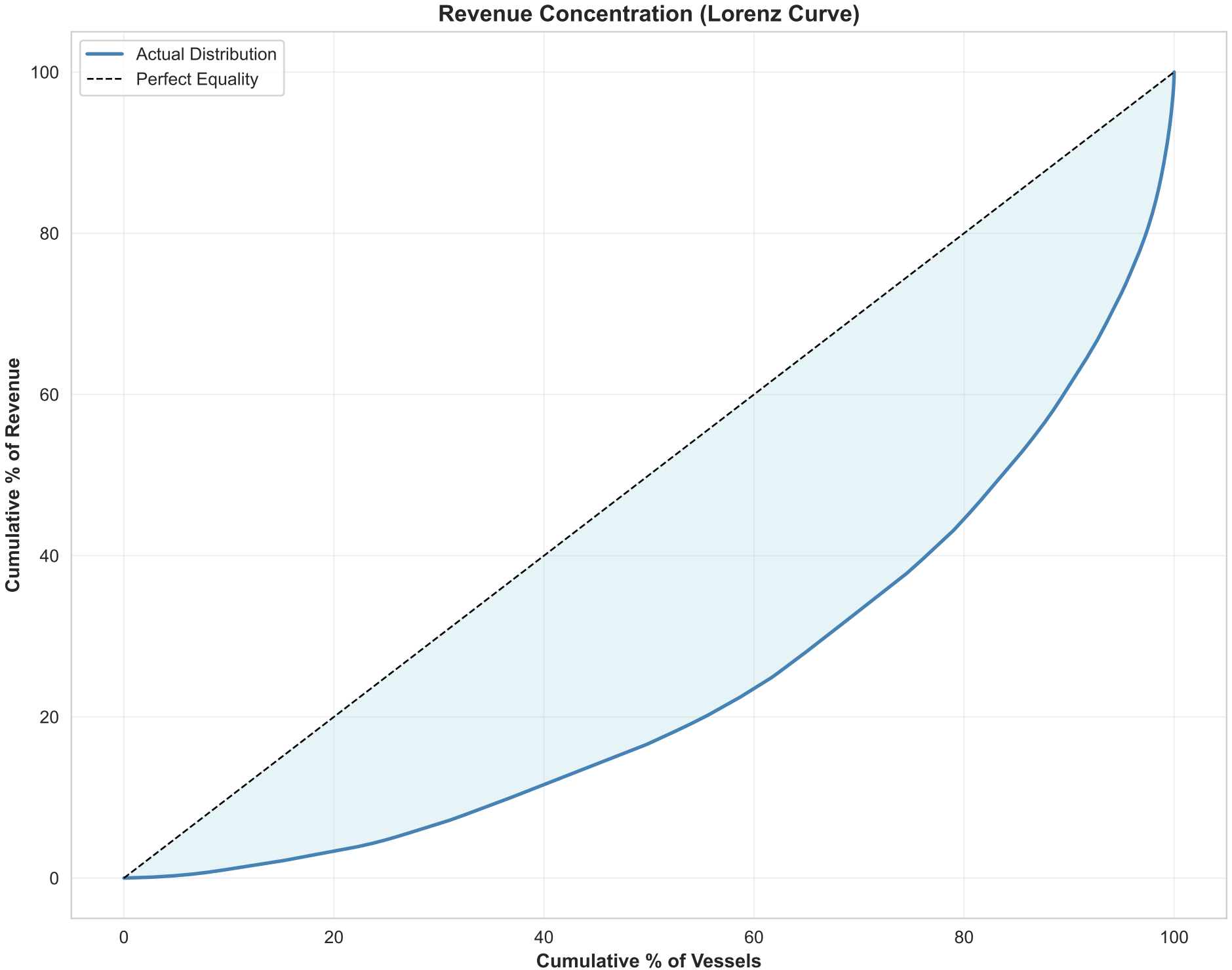
3. Operator Market Share Analysis

Analysis of top vessels (proxy for operators) by revenue


Top 20 Vessels by Revenue (2023)
KING ARTHUR
TROPIC TIDE
TROPIC JADE
BLUE STAR
MCKEIL SPIRIT
NACC ALICUDI
MARGARITAVILLE AT SEA PARADISE
TROPIC MIST
ALGOMA VALOUR
CSL TACOMA
ALGOMA INTEGRITY
BAHAMA SPIRIT
IVER PROSPERITY
TROPIC LURE
POLARIS VOYAGER
PEGASUS VOYAGER
IVER BRIGHT
RELIANCE II
CSL FRONTIER
NEW ENGLAND
0.0
0.2
0.4
0.6
0.8
1.0
1.2
1.4
Revenue ($ Million)

Market Concentration by Top Vessels (2023)



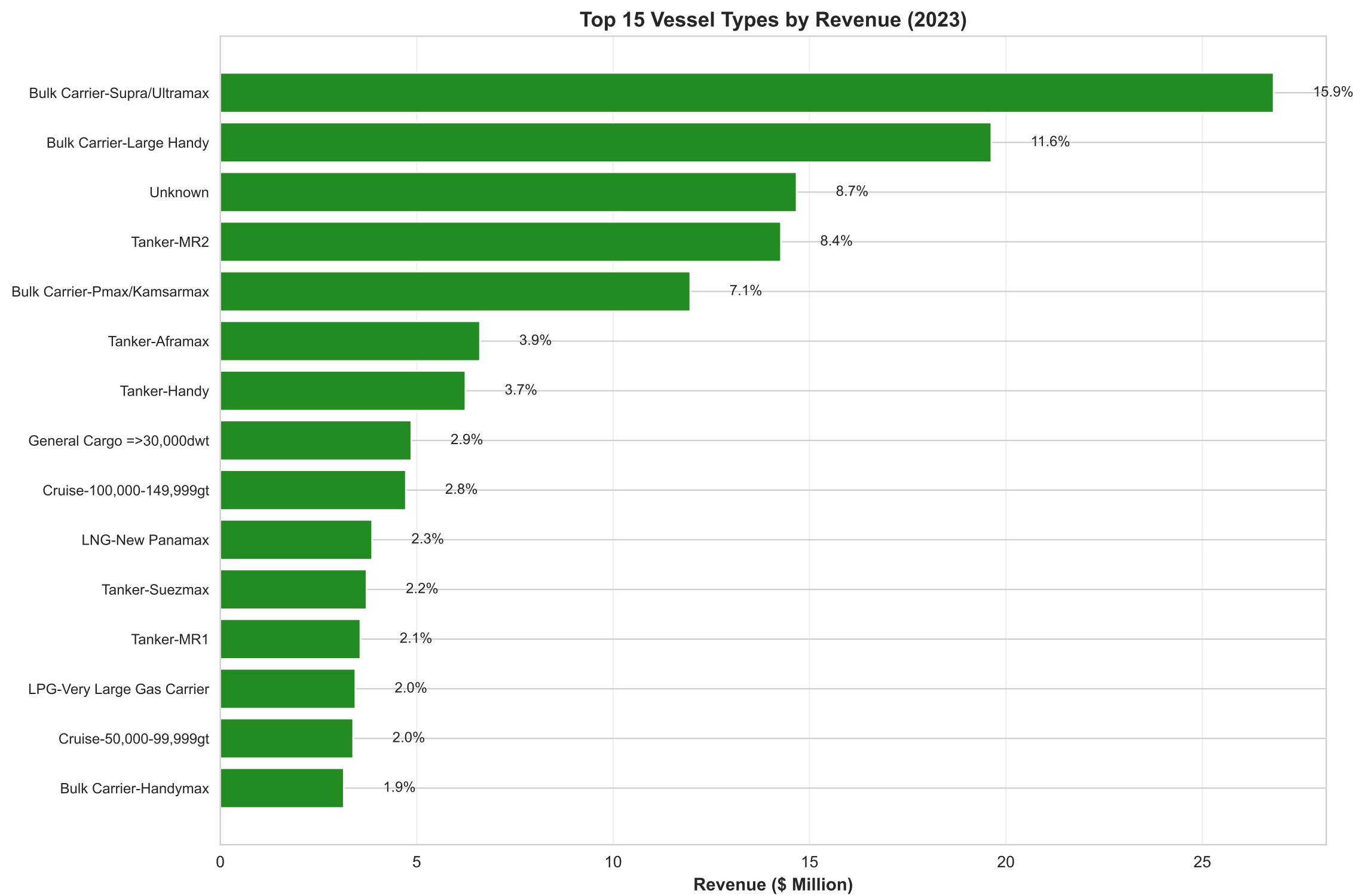

Revenue Concentration (Lorenz Curve)
Actual Distribution
Perfect Equality
Cumulative % of Revenue
Cumulative % of Vessels
0
20
40
60
80
100

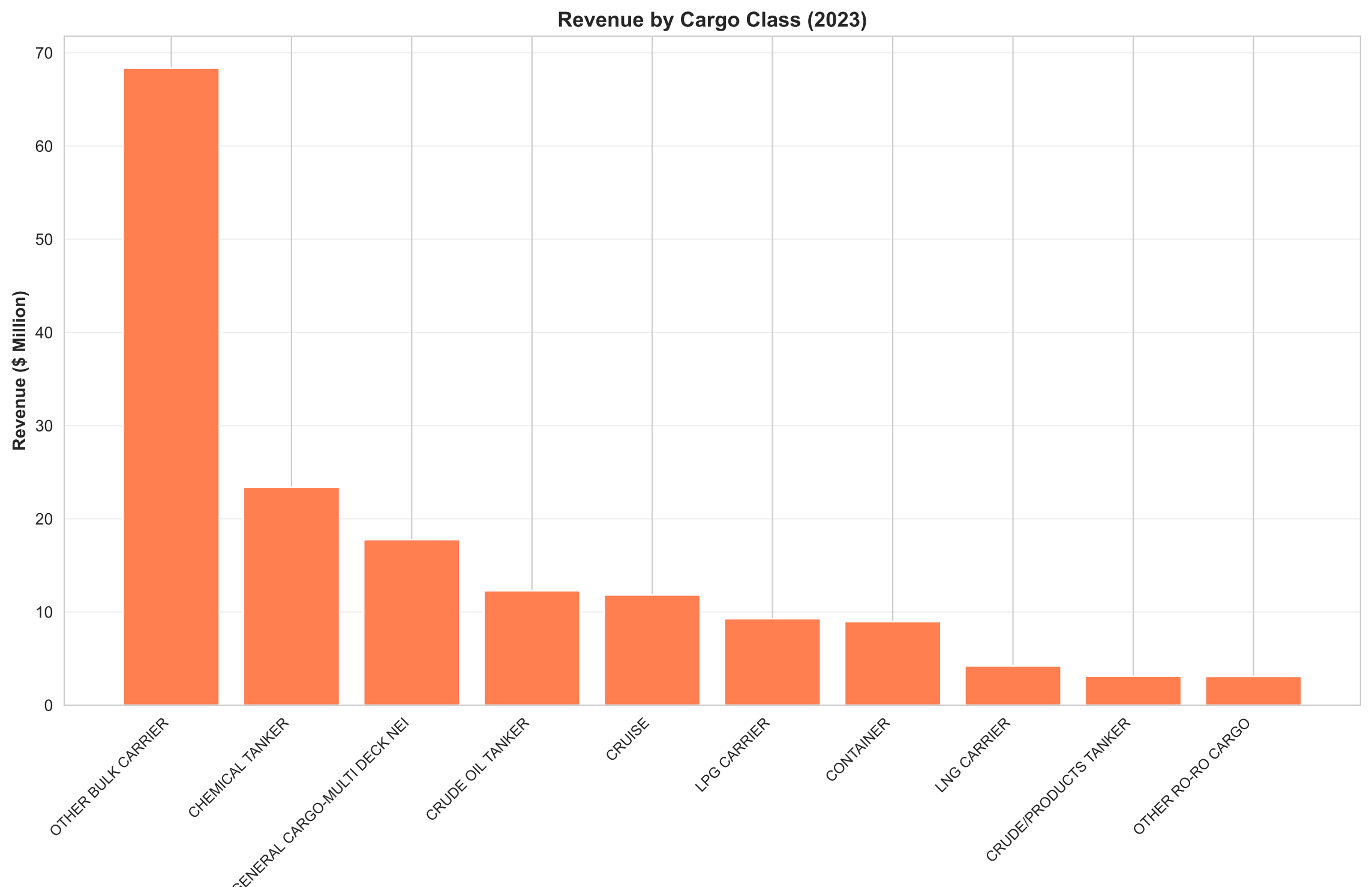
Top 50 Vessels by Revenue

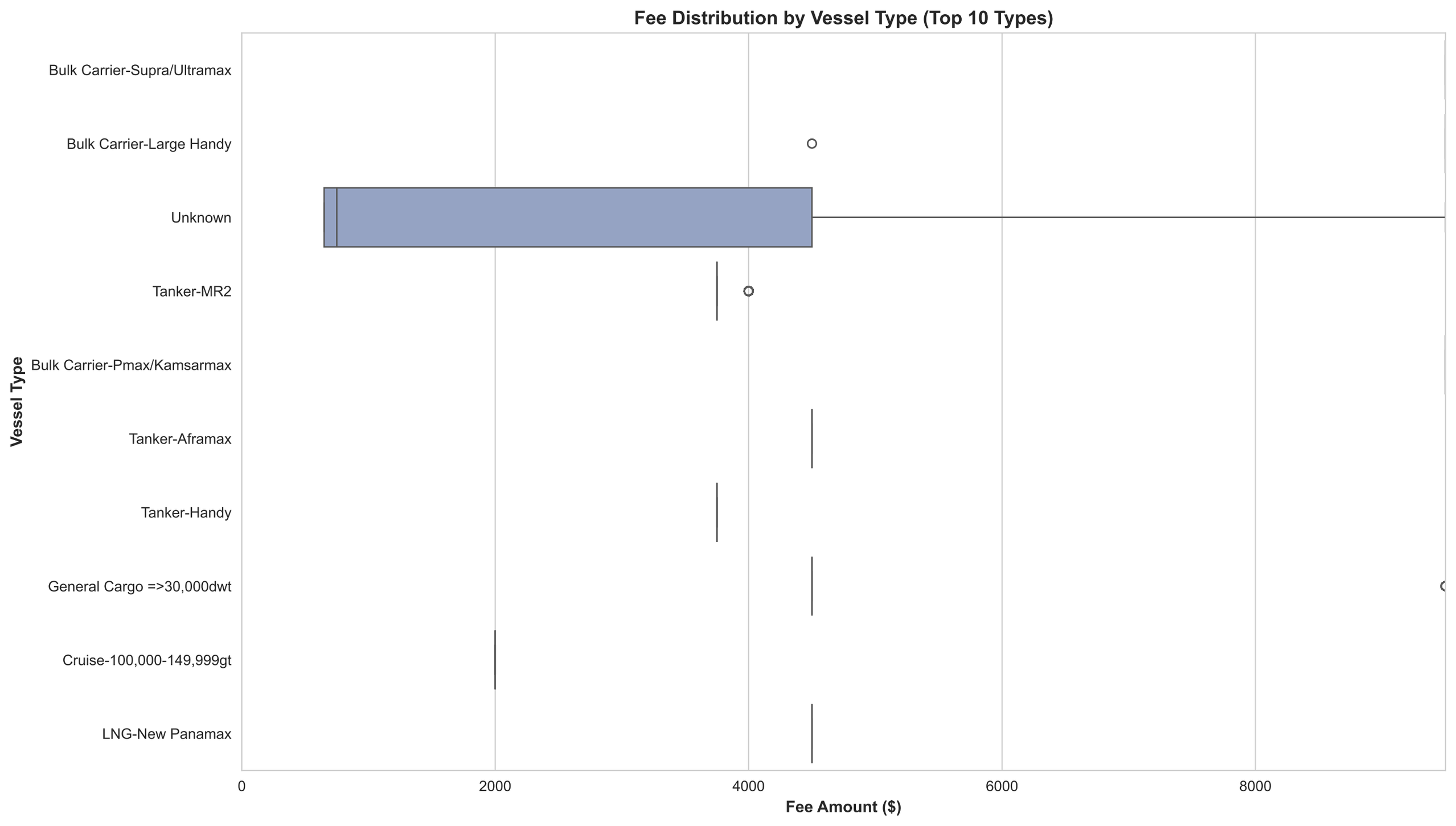
Vessel_ID	Fee_Adj	Clearances
KING ARTHUR	$1,496,250	399
TROPIC TIDE	$513,000	114
TROPIC JADE	$495,000	110
BLUE STAR	$437,000	46
MCKEIL SPIRIT	$418,000	44
NACC ALICUDI	$408,500	43
MARGARITAVILLE AT SEA PARAD	$336,000	168
TROPIC MIST	$310,500	69
ALGOMA VALOUR	$285,000	30
CSL TACOMA	$285,000	30
ALGOMA INTEGRITY	$285,000	30
BAHAMA SPIRIT	$275,500	29
IVER PROSPERITY	$262,500	70
TROPIC LURE	$261,000	58
POLARIS VOYAGER	$256,500	57
PEGASUS VOYAGER	$252,000	56
IVER BRIGHT	$248,000	62
RELIANCE II	$247,500	55
CSL FRONTIER	$247,000	26
NEW ENGLAND	$240,000	64
CARNIVAL CONQUEST	$238,000	119
NACC NEWYORKER	$237,500	25
TAURUS	$233,800	37
NOR'EASTER	$228,750	61
GREAT EASTERN	$228,750	61
EAGLE HYDRA	$225,000	50
PROGRESO	$220,500	49
FREEDOM OF THE SEAS	$208,000	104
CARNIVAL LIBERTY	$206,000	103
DISNEY WISH	$204,000	102
CARNIVAL RADIANCE	$204,000	102
CARNIVAL GLORY	$200,000	100
EAGLE SAN JUAN	$193,500	43
PELAGIC EXPRESS	$193,500	43
OCEAN EXPRESS	$193,500	43
LIBERTY OF THE SEAS	$190,000	95
SCARLET LADY	$188,000	94
BETTY K VI	$184,500	41
CARIBE NAVIGATOR	$184,500	41
IRELAND	$180,500	19
CSL KOASEK	$180,500	19
VANQUISH	$180,000	40
MSC MERAVIGLIA	$178,000	89
INDEPENDENCE OF THE SEAS	$176,000	88
PALANCA RIO	$176,000	44
APOLLO VOYAGER	$175,500	39
DONALD M. JAMES	$171,000	18
GUADALUPE	$171,000	38
CARNIVAL SUNRISE	$170,000	85
COOL SPIRIT	$166,500	37

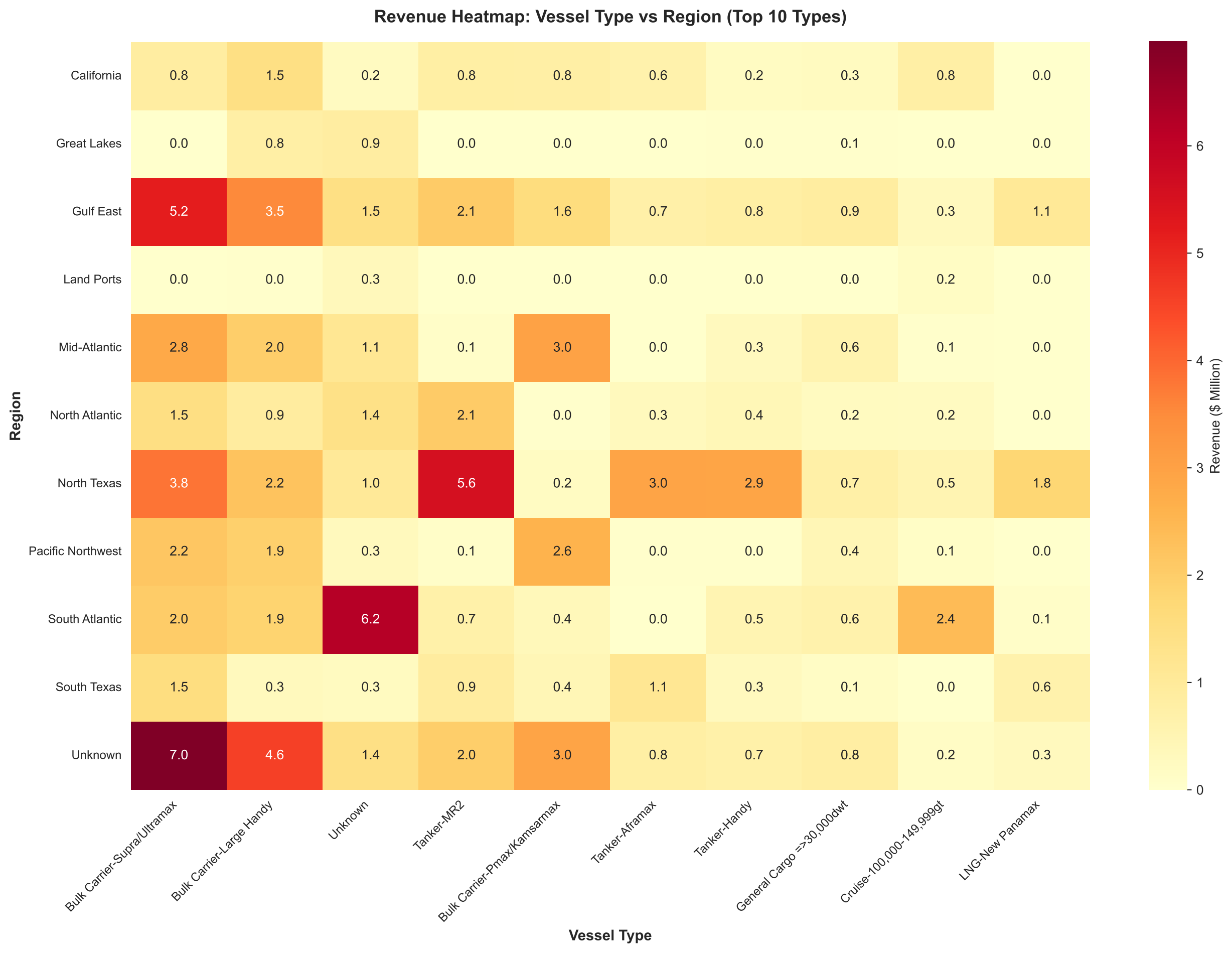
4. Vessel Type Revenue Analysis

Revenue distribution across vessel types and cargo classes


Top 15 Vessel Types by Revenue (2023)
Bulk Carrier-Supra/Ultramax
Bulk Carrier-Large Handy
Unknown
Tanker-MR2
Bulk Carrier-Pmax/Kamsarmax
Tanker-Aframax
Tanker-Handy
General Cargo =>30,000dwt
Cruise-100,000-149,999gt
LNG-New Panamax
Tanker-Suezmax
Tanker-MR1
LPG-Very Large Gas Carrier
Cruise-50,000-99,999gt
Bulk Carrier-Handymax
15.9%
11.6%
8.7%
8.4%
7.1%
3.9%
3.7%
2.9%
2.8%
2.3%
2.2%
2.1%
2.0%
2.0%
1.9%
0
5
10
15
20
25
Revenue ($ Million)


Revenue by Cargo Class (2023)
Revenue ($ Million)
0
10
20
30
40
50
60
70
OTHER BULK CARRIER
CHEMICAL TANKER
GENERAL CARGO-MULTI DECK NEI
CRUDE OIL TANKER
CRUISE
LPG CARRIER
CONTAINER
LNG CARRIER
CRUDE/PRODUCTS TANKER
OTHER RO-RO CARGO


Fee Distribution by Vessel Type (Top 10 Types)
Vessel Type
Bulk Carrier-Supra/Ultramax
Bulk Carrier-Large Handy
Unknown
Tanker-MR2
Bulk Carrier-Pmax/Kamsarmax
Tanker-Aframax
Tanker-Handy
General Cargo =>30,000dwt
Cruise-100,000-149,999gt
LNG-New Panamax
0
2000
4000
6000
8000
Fee Amount ($)


Revenue Heatmap: Vessel Type vs Region (Top 10 Types)
Region
California 0.8 1.5 0.2 0.8 0.8 0.6 0.2 0.3 0.8 0.0
Great Lakes 0.0 0.8 0.9 0.0 0.0 0.0 0.0 0.1 0.0 0.0
Gulf East 5.2 3.5 1.5 2.1 1.6 0.7 0.8 0.9 0.3 1.1
Land Ports 0.0 0.0 0.3 0.0 0.0 0.0 0.0 0.0 0.2 0.0
Mid-Atlantic 2.8 2.0 1.1 0.1 3.0 0.0 0.3 0.6 0.1 0.0
North Atlantic 1.5 0.9 1.4 2.1 0.0 0.3 0.4 0.2 0.2 0.0
North Texas 3.8 2.2 1.0 5.6 0.2 3.0 2.9 0.7 0.5 1.8
Pacific Northwest 2.2 1.9 0.3 0.1 2.6 0.0 0.0 0.4 0.1 0.0
South Atlantic 2.0 1.9 6.2 0.7 0.4 0.0 0.5 0.6 2.4 0.1
South Texas 1.5 0.3 0.3 0.9 0.4 1.1 0.3 0.1 0.0 0.6
Unknown 7.0 4.6 1.4 2.0 3.0 0.8 0.7 0.8 0.2 0.3
Bulk Carrier-Supra/Ultramax
Bulk Carrier-Large Handy
Unknown
Tanker-MR2
Bulk Carrier-Pmax/Kamsarmax
Tanker-Aframax
Tanker-Handy
General Cargo =>30,000dwt
Cruise-100,000-149,999gt
LNG-New Panamax
Vessel Type
Revenue ($ Million)
0
1
2
3
4
5
6

Revenue Disparity Analysis

Highest Revenue Type: Bulk Carrier-Supra/Ultramax ($26.8M)

Lowest Revenue Type: LNG-Q Flex ($0.0M)

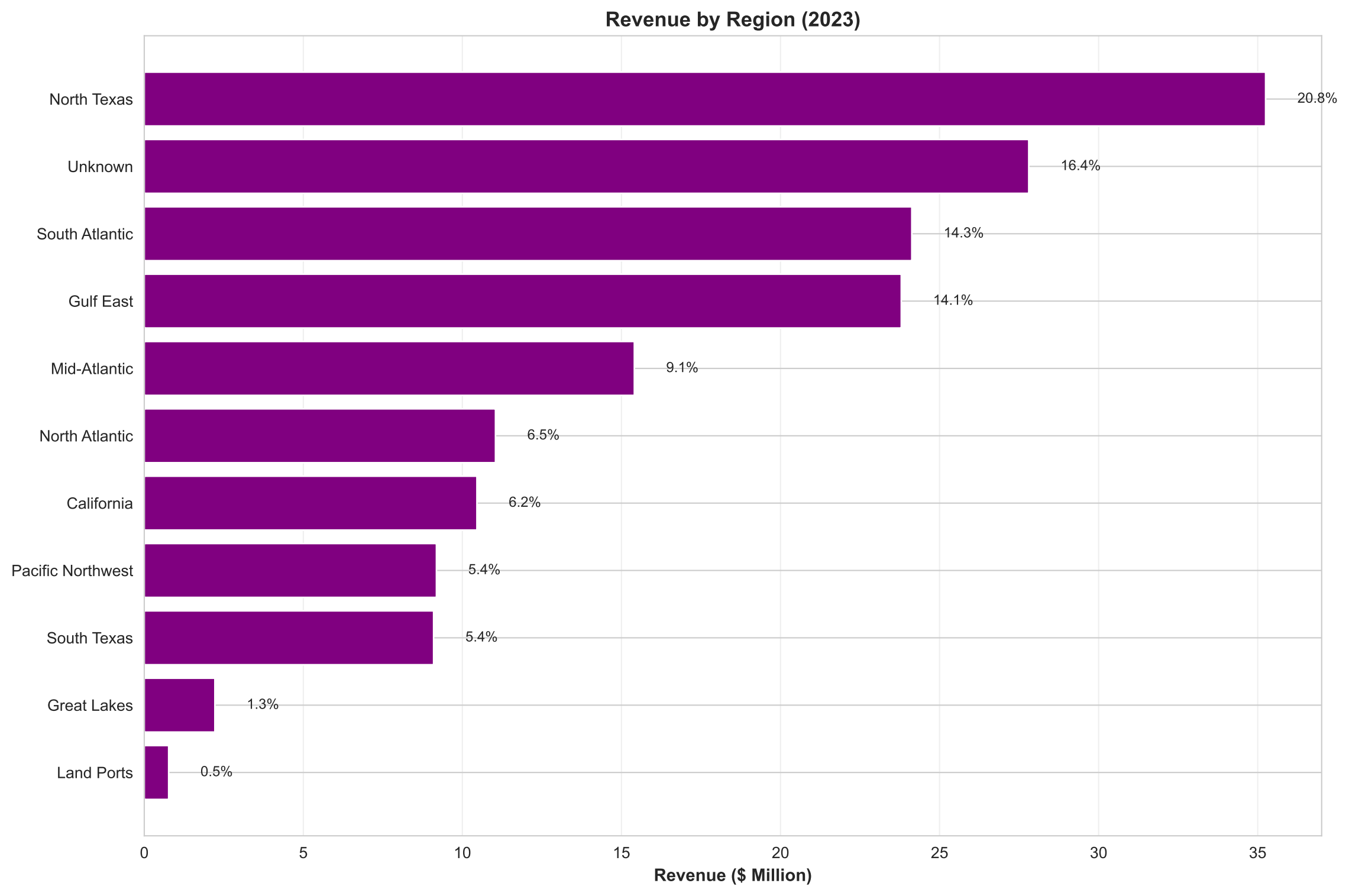
Revenue Disparity Ratio: 5958.7x

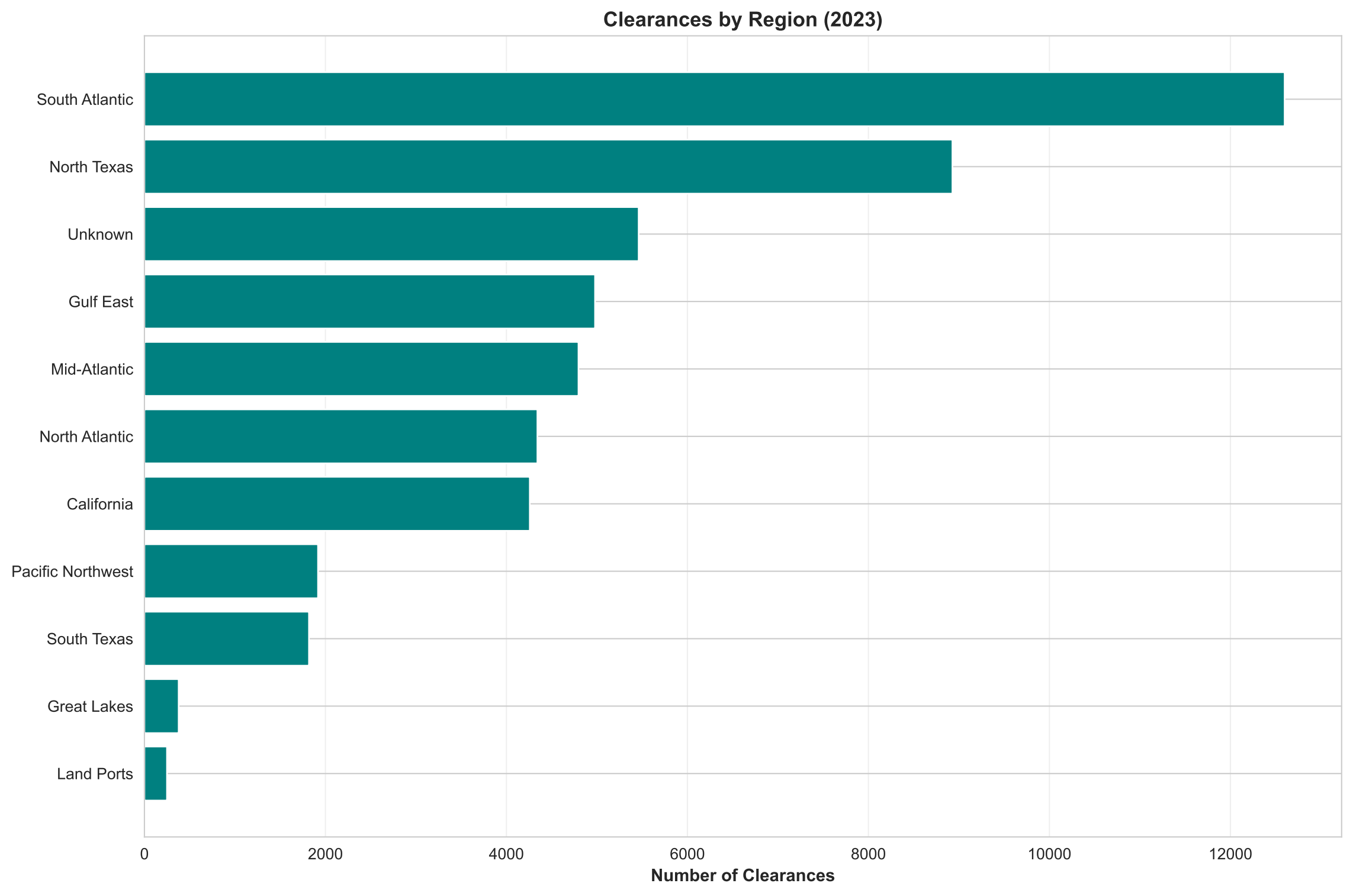
Highest Avg Fee: $9,656

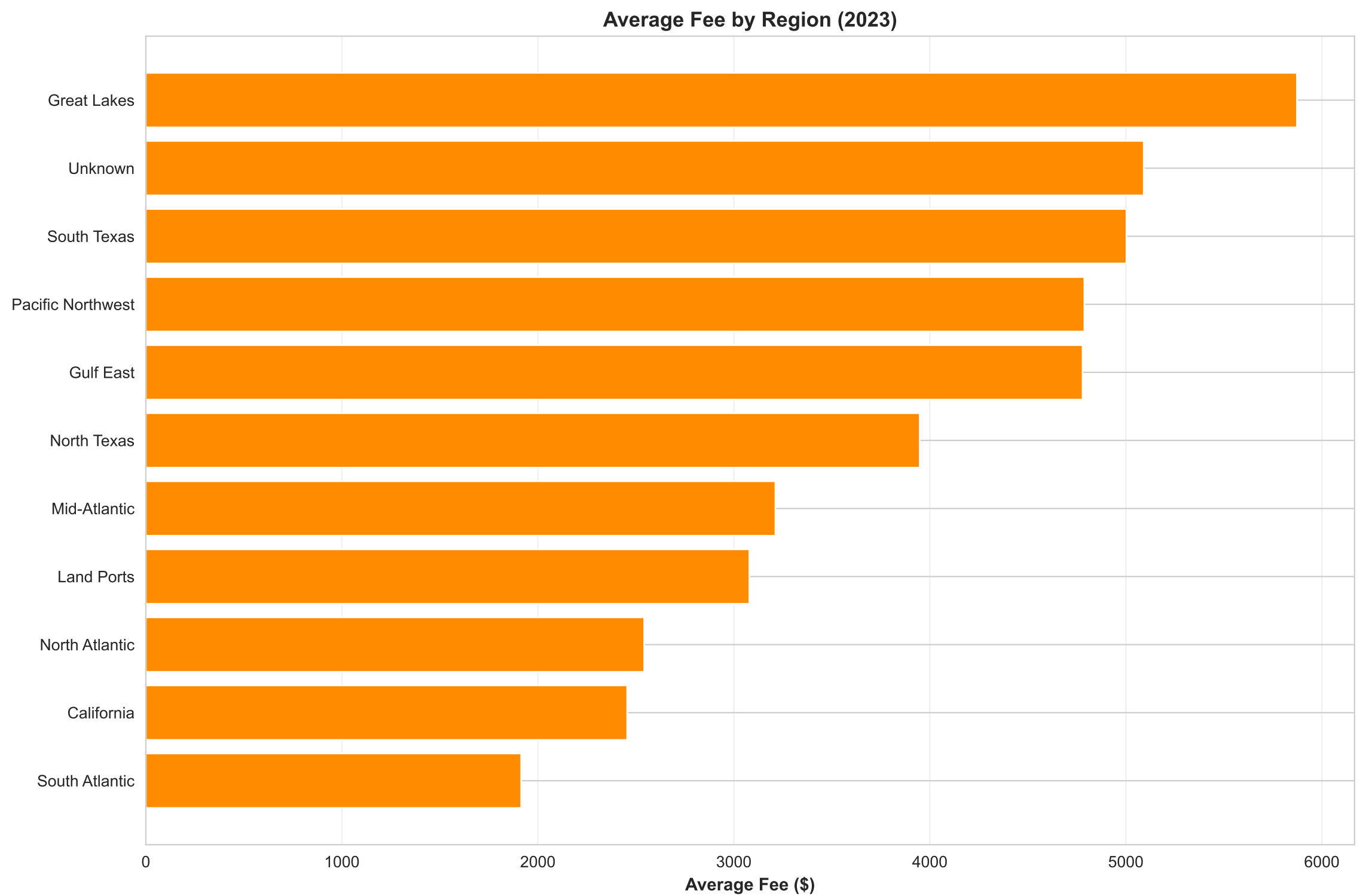
Lowest Avg Fee: $4,500

5. Regional Market Analysis

Revenue and clearance distribution across US port regions


Revenue by Region (2023)
North Texas
Unknown
South Atlantic
Gulf East
Mid-Atlantic
North Atlantic
California
Pacific Northwest
South Texas
Great Lakes
Land Ports
20.8%
16.4%
14.3%
14.1%
9.1%
6.5%
6.2%
5.4%
5.4%
1.3%
0.5%
0
5
10
15
20
25
30
35
Revenue ($ Million)


Clearances by Region (2023)
South Atlantic
North Texas
Unknown
Gulf East
Mid-Atlantic
North Atlantic
California
Pacific Northwest
South Texas
Great Lakes
Land Ports
0
2000
4000
6000
8000
10000
12000
Number of Clearances


Average Fee by Region (2023)
Great Lakes
Unknown
South Texas
Pacific Northwest
Gulf East
North Texas
Mid-Atlantic
Land Ports
North Atlantic
California
South Atlantic
0
1000
2000
3000
4000
5000
6000
Average Fee ($)

Regional Statistics

Port_Region	Total_Revenue	Clearances	Avg_Fee	Revenue_Pct
North Texas	$35,248,350	8,928	$3,948	$21
Unknown	$27,803,200	5,461	$5,091	$16
South Atlantic	$24,127,350	12,599	$1,915	$14
Gulf East	$23,796,150	4,979	$4,779	$14
Mid-Atlantic	$15,404,950	4,796	$3,212	$9
North Atlantic	$11,040,000	4,342	$2,543	$7
California	$10,457,050	4,258	$2,456	$6
Pacific Northwest	$9,184,000	1,918	$4,788	$5
South Texas	$9,095,150	1,818	$5,003	$5
Great Lakes	$2,220,000	378	$5,873	$1
Land Ports	$766,750	249	$3,079	$0

6. Average Revenue Per Ship Analysis

Analysis of revenue distribution across individual vessels

Per-Ship Revenue Metrics

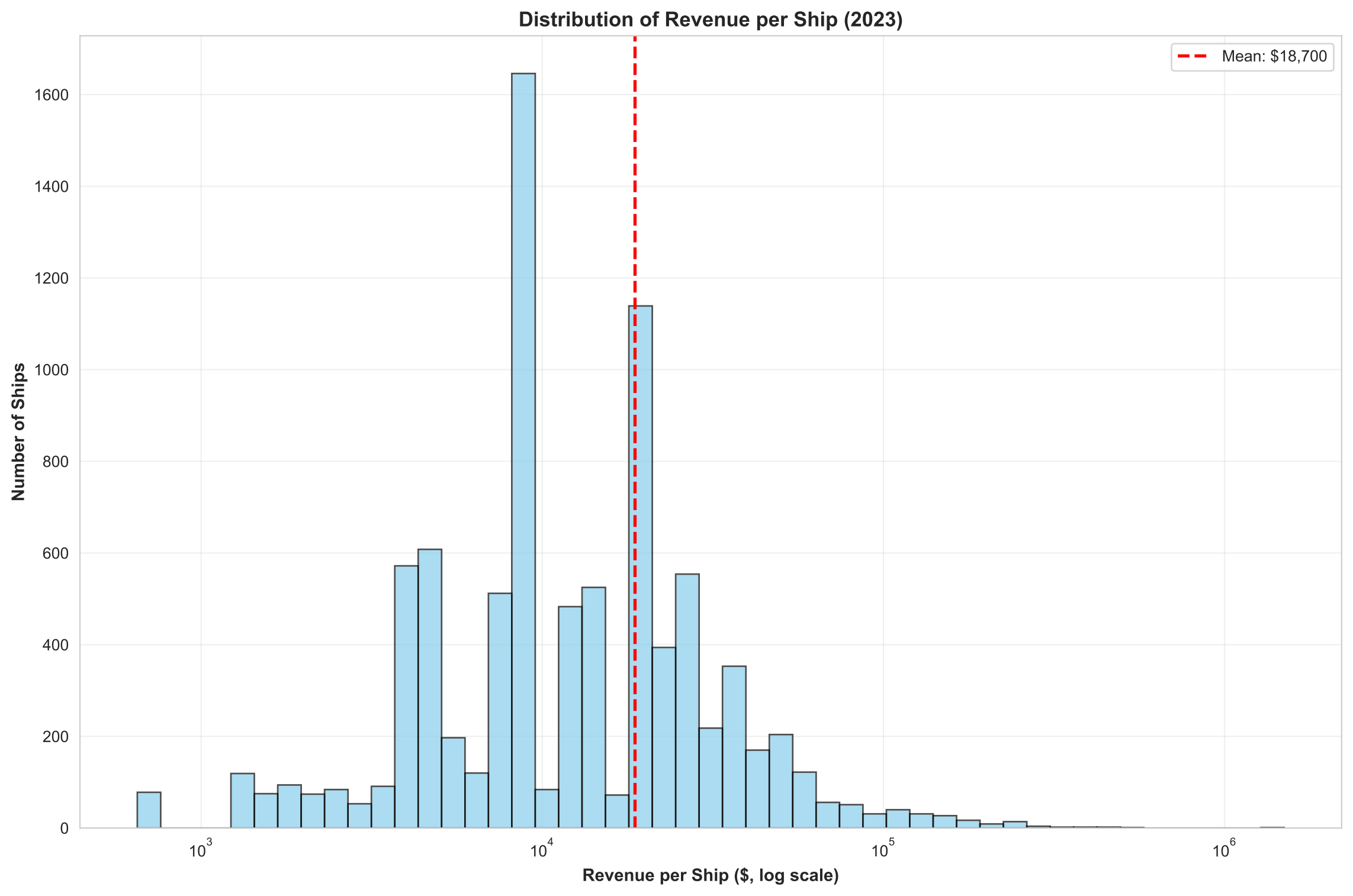
Total Unique Vessels: 9,045

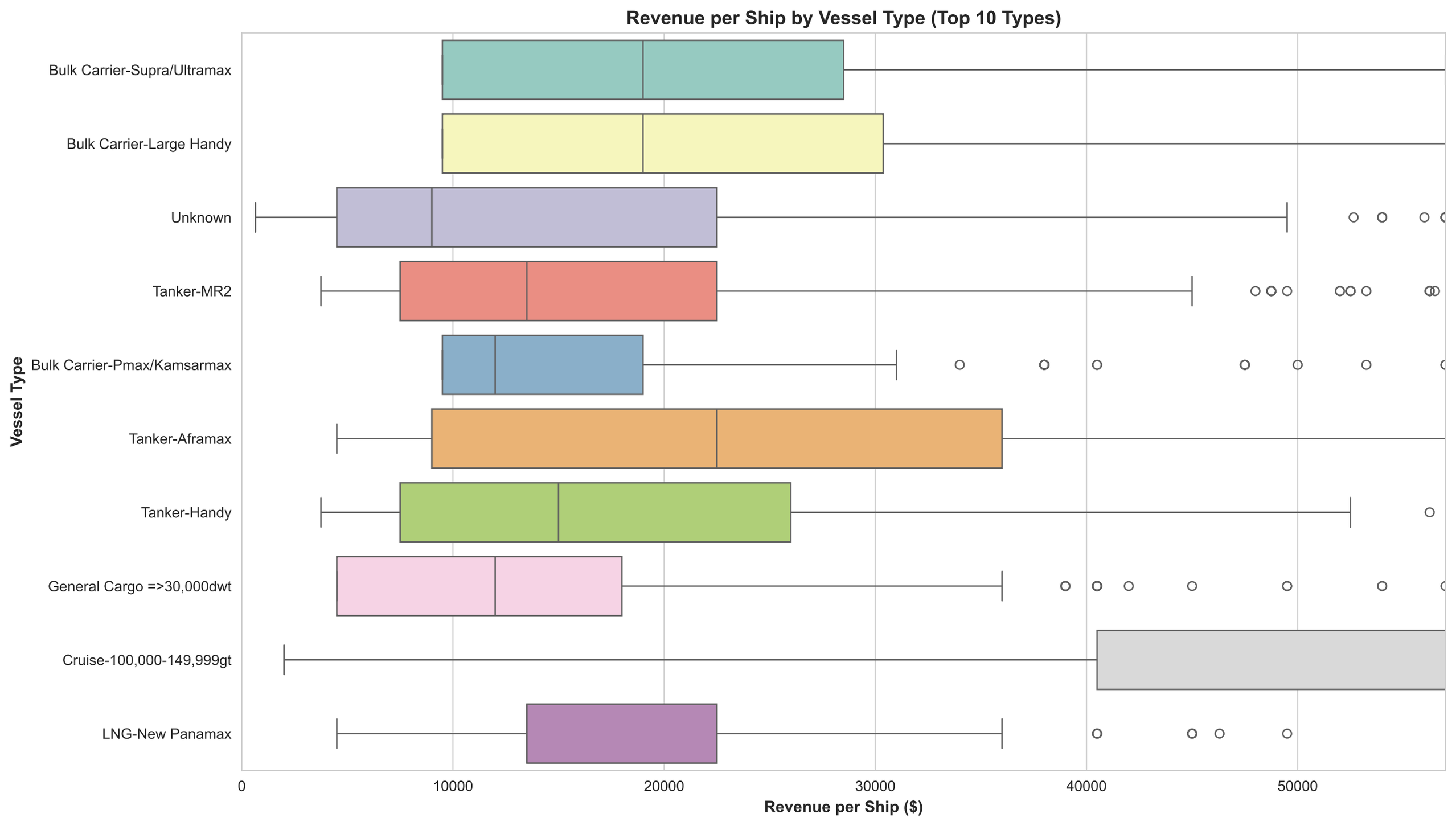
Average Revenue per Ship: $18,700

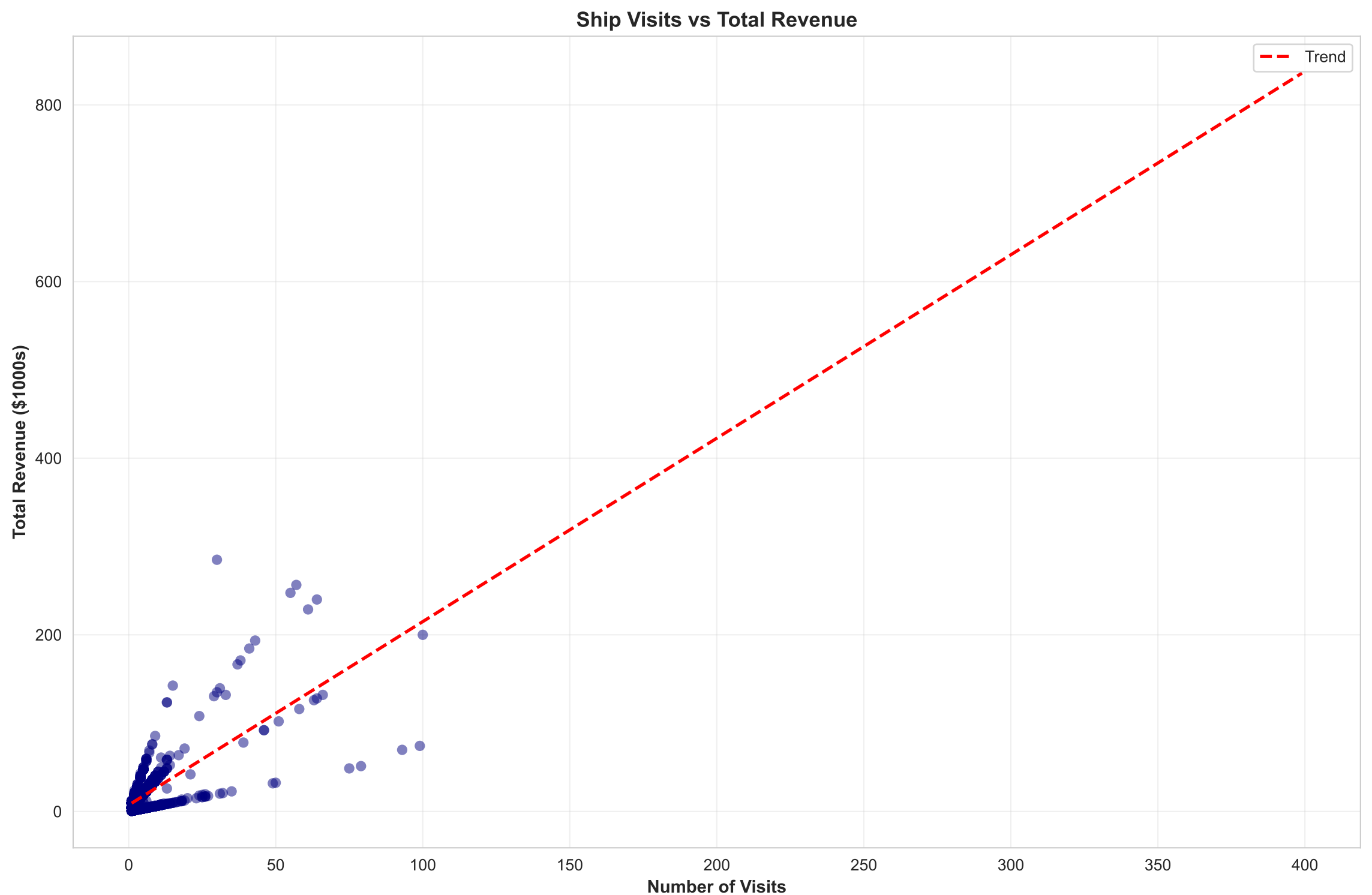
Median Revenue per Ship: $11,050

10th Percentile: $3,750

90th Percentile: $38,000


Distribution of Revenue per Ship (2023)
Mean: $18,700
Number of Ships
0
200
400
600
800
1000
1200
1400
1600
10^3
10^4
10^5
10^6
Revenue per Ship ($, log scale)


Revenue per Ship by Vessel Type (Top 10 Types)
Vessel Type
Bulk Carrier-Supra/Ultramax
Bulk Carrier-Large Handy
Unknown
Tanker-MR2
Bulk Carrier-Pmax/Kamsarmax
Tanker-Aframax
Tanker-Handy
General Cargo =>30,000dwt
Cruise-100,000-149,999gt
LNG-New Panamax
0
10000
20000
30000
40000
50000
Revenue per Ship ($)


Ship Visits vs Total Revenue
Trend
Total Revenue ($1000s)
800
600
400
200
0
0
50
100
150
200
250
300
350
400
Number of Visits

7. Grain Shipment Analysis

Detailed analysis of grain export clearances

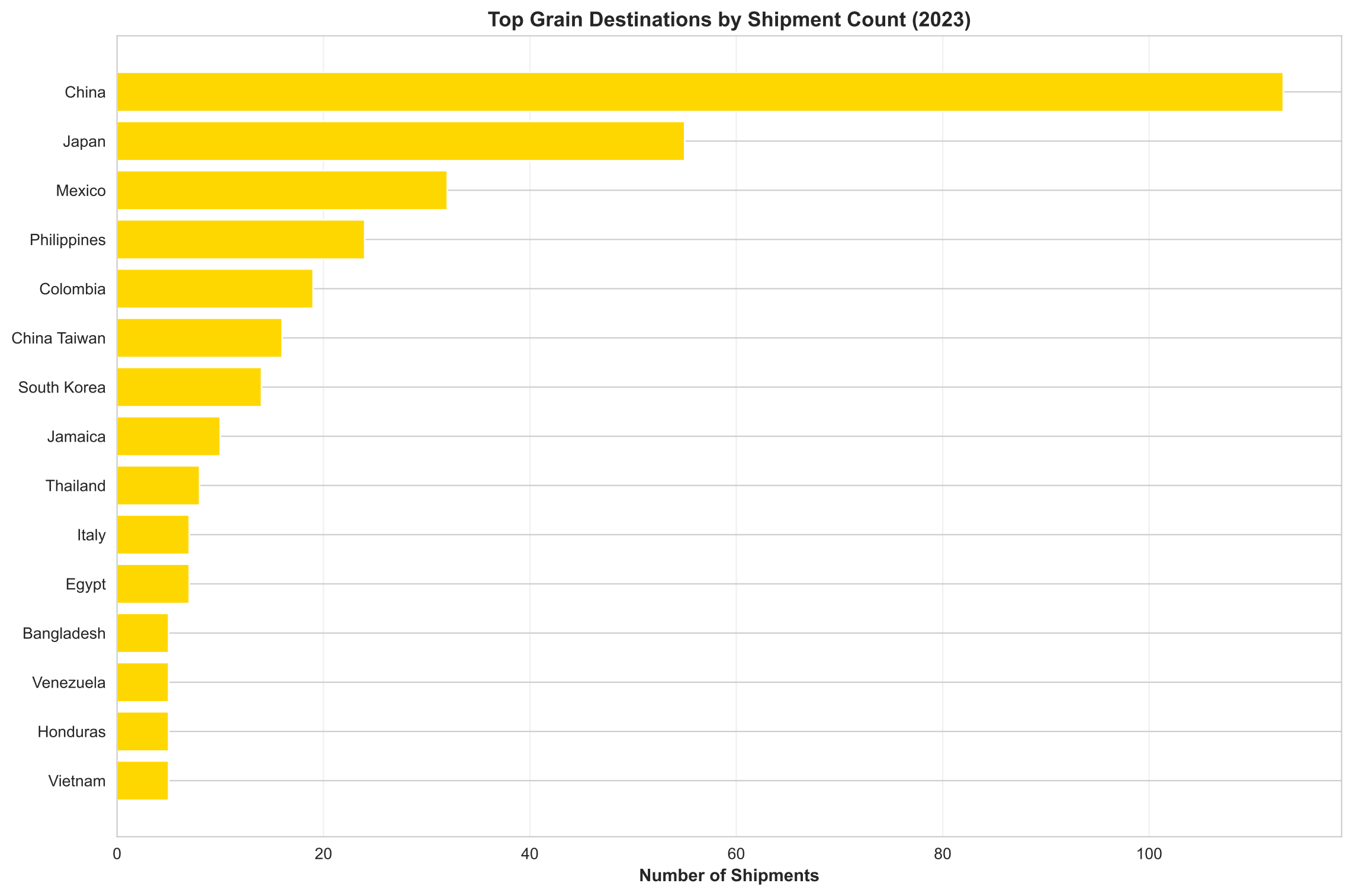
Grain Shipment Metrics

Grain Clearances: 409

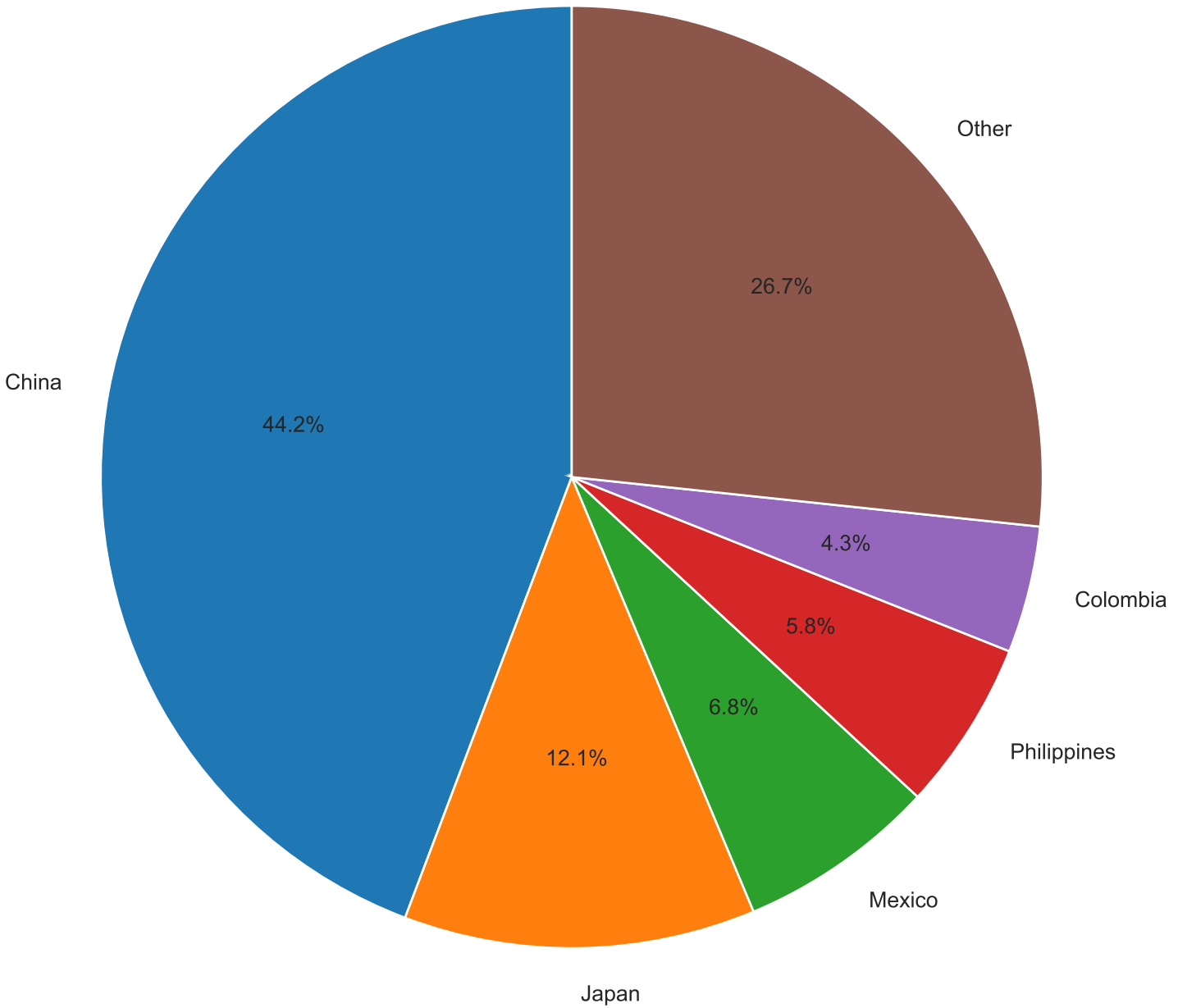
Percentage of Total: 0.8%

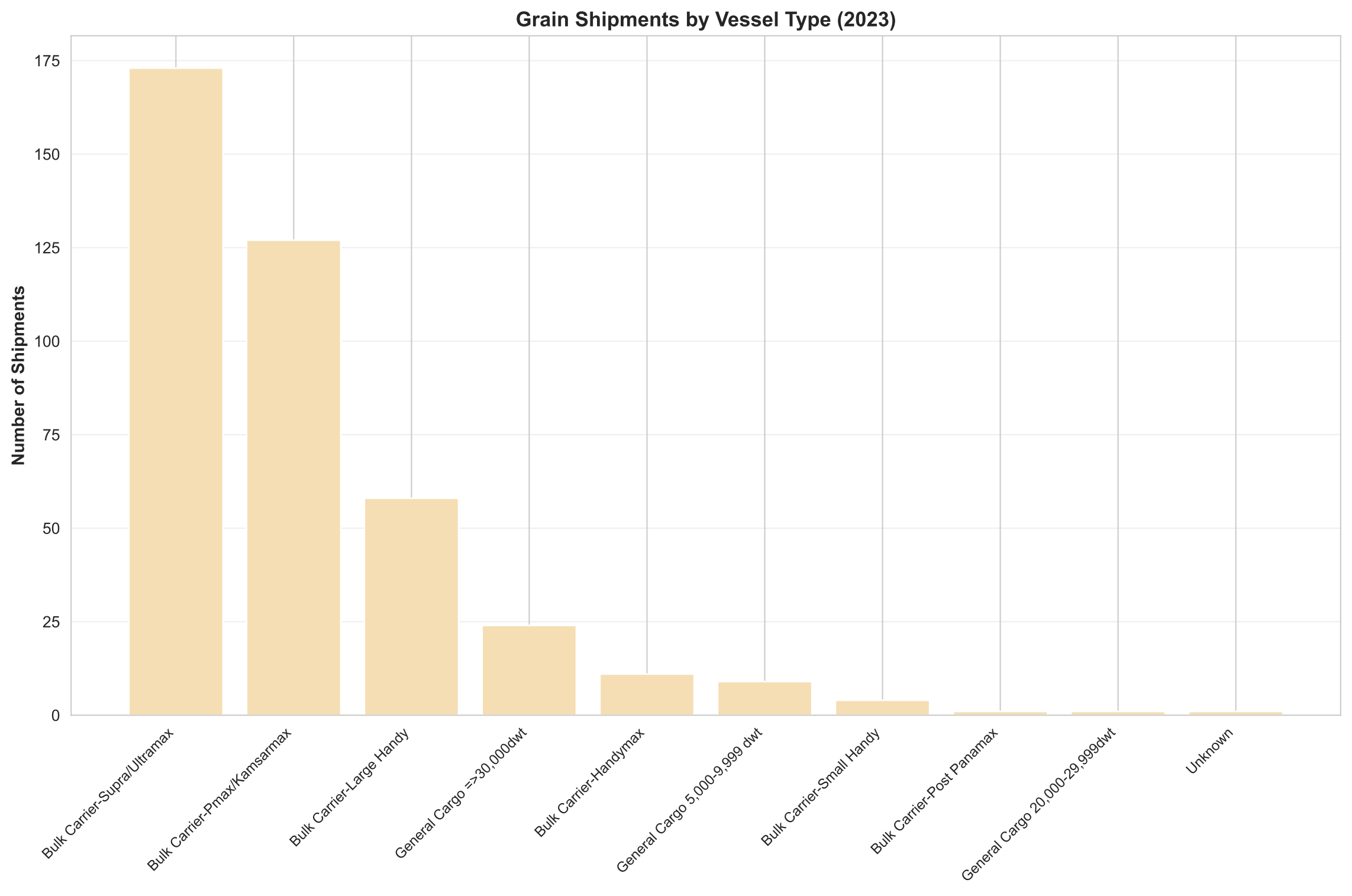
Grain Revenue: $4,908,000

Total Tonnage: 17,436,622 MT


Top Grain Destinations by Shipment Count (2023)
China
Japan
Mexico
Philippines
Colombia
China Taiwan
South Korea
Jamaica
Thailand
Italy
Egypt
Bangladesh
Venezuela
Honduras
Vietnam
0
20
40
60
80
100
Number of Shipments

Grain Tonnage Distribution by Destination (2023)




Grain Shipments by Vessel Type (2023)
Number of Shipments
175
150
125
100
75
50
25
0
Bulk Carrier-Supra/Ultramax
Bulk Carrier-Pmax/Kamsarmax
Bulk Carrier-Large Handy
General Cargo =>30,000dwt
Bulk Carrier-Handymax
General Cargo 5,000-9,999 dwt
Bulk Carrier-Small Handy
Bulk Carrier-Post Panamax
General Cargo 20,000-29,999dwt
Unknown

8. Conclusions & Market Insights

Key takeaways and strategic observations

Market Insights

- The US port clearance market generated $169.1M in 2023
- Market shows moderate concentration with top 10 vessels controlling 2.9%
- Significant revenue disparity across vessel types: 5958.7x ratio
- Regional distribution varies significantly, with top region generating 20.8% of revenue
- Average revenue per vessel is $18,700, with significant variance
- Grain exports represent 0.8% of clearances but contribute $4.9M in revenue
- Multi-visit vessels indicate established trade routes and partnerships
- Vessel type diversity (60 types) reflects varied cargo and operational requirements